

Sydney Travel Guide

Quick Facts

- **Country:** Australia
- **Language:** English (Australian accent and slang)
- **Currency:** Australian Dollar (AUD, \$)
- **Time Zone:** Australian Eastern Standard Time (AEST, UTC+10; AEDT UTC+11 in summer)
- **Emergency Number:** 000 (police, ambulance, fire)
- **Dialing Code:** +61
- **State:** New South Wales (capital city)
- **Population:** ~5.3 million (metropolitan area)

Visa Requirements

Entry Rules by Nationality

Australia has strict entry requirements for all visitors:

- **US Citizens:** Electronic Travel Authority (ETA) or eVisitor required (free), apply online, valid 12 months, stays up to **3 months**
- **UK Citizens:** eVisitor required (free), apply online, valid 12 months, stays up to **3 months**
- **Canadian Citizens:** eVisitor required (free), apply online, valid 12 months, stays up to **3 months**
- **EU Citizens:** eVisitor required (free), apply online, valid 12 months, stays up to **3 months**
- **Other Nationals:** Check [Australian Department of Home Affairs](#) for visa requirements
- **Working Holiday:** Many countries eligible for Working Holiday Visa (12 months, ages 18-30/35)

Important Requirements

- **Apply Before Travel:** ETA/eVisitor must be approved before boarding flight
- **Passport Validity:** Must be valid for entire duration of stay
- **Biosecurity:** Strict declaration requirements - failure to declare can result in fines up to \$420 or prosecution

- **No Visa on Arrival:** Must have visa before departure
- **Character Requirements:** May need police certificate for longer stays
- **Health Insurance:** Not mandatory but highly recommended (medical costs are high)

Biosecurity (VERY IMPORTANT!)

Australia has the world's strictest biosecurity laws:

- **Declare ALL:** Food, plant material, animal products, hiking boots, camping gear
- **Fines:** \$420-\$2,340 on-the-spot fines, potential prosecution
- **Detector Dogs:** At airports - don't try to hide anything
- **Common Violations:** Undeclared fruit, nuts, honey, seeds, wooden souvenirs, dirty shoes
- **When in Doubt:** Declare it (declaration is not illegal, hiding is)

Best Time to Visit

Summer (December - February)

- **Weather:** Hot and sunny (18-26°C / 64-79°F, but can reach 35-40°C / 95-104°F on hot days)
- **Pros:** Beach season, outdoor festivals, long days, festive atmosphere (Christmas/New Year)
- **Cons:** Peak tourist season, higher prices, crowded beaches, occasional extreme heat
- **Best for:** Beach lovers, outdoor activities, festivals, celebrating Christmas in summer

Autumn (March - May)

- **Weather:** Warm and pleasant (14-23°C / 57-73°F)
- **Pros:** Beautiful weather, fewer crowds, lower prices, harvest festivals
- **Cons:** Can be rainy in late autumn
- **Best for:** Sightseeing, hiking, wine tours, comfortable weather

Winter (June - August)

- **Weather:** Mild and cool (8-17°C / 46-63°F)
- **Pros:** Off-season prices, Vivid Sydney festival (May-June), whale watching, clear skies, fewer tourists
- **Cons:** Too cold for swimming, shorter days, some rain
- **Best for:** Budget travelers, Vivid Sydney, whale watching, cultural activities

Spring (September - November)

- **Weather:** Perfect (11-23°C / 52-73°F)
- **Pros:** Ideal weather, flowers blooming, Sculpture by the Sea, comfortable sightseeing
- **Cons:** Can be windy
- **Best for:** First-time visitors, outdoor activities, photography

Peak Season: December-February (book 3-6 months ahead) **Shoulder Season:** March-May, September-November (ideal) **Off Season:** June-August (great value but cooler)

Pro Tip: September-November and March-May offer the best combination of weather, lower prices, and smaller crowds.

Top Attractions

Attraction	Area	Entry Fee	Hours	Best Time to Visit	Must-Do Experience
Sydney Opera House	Circular Quay	Tours \$43 (performances vary)	Tours 9:00-17:00 daily	Sunrise or sunset from outside	Guided tour or attend a performance
Sydney Harbour Bridge	The Rocks	BridgeClimb \$174-\$404	Climbs: dawn to night	Sunset climb for views	BridgeClimb or walk across (free)
Bondi Beach	Eastern Suburbs	Free	24/7	Morning for swim, afternoon for sun	Swim, surf, Bondi to Coogee coastal walk
The Rocks	The Rocks	Free (markets/museums vary)	Markets: Sat-Sun 10:00-17:00	Weekend for markets	Weekend markets, historic pubs
Darling Harbour	Darling Harbour	Free (attractions vary)	24/7	Evening for lights and dining	SEA LIFE Aquarium, Chinese Garden
Taronga Zoo	Mosman	\$51 adults, \$28 child	9:30-17:00	Morning feeding times	See Aussie animals with harbor views
Royal Botanic Garden	CBD	Free	7:00-sunset	Morning or late afternoon	Mrs Macquarie's Chair viewpoint
Manly Beach	Northern Beaches	Free	24/7	Any time (ferry ride scenic)	Ferry from Circular Quay, surf
Blue Mountains	Day trip (100km west)	Park entry \$8 per car	24/7 (attractions vary)	Weekday for fewer crowds	Three Sisters, scenic railway
Barangaroo Reserve	Barangaroo	Free	24/7	Sunset for harbor views	Harbourfront walk, dining
Queen Victoria Building (QVB)	CBD	Free (shopping)	9:00-18:00 (varies)	Afternoon	Architecture, shopping, tea
	CBD	\$29-35	9:00-21:00	Sunset	

Attraction	Area	Entry Fee	Hours	Best Time to Visit	Must-Do Experience
Sydney Tower Eye					360° views from 250m high

Insider Tips

- **Opal Card:** Essential for public transport - tap on/off, daily cap \$17.80 on weekends
- **Free Ferries:** Manly ferry is tourist attraction AND transport (use Opal, not tourist ferry)
- **Beaches:** Bondi is famous but crowded; try Coogee, Bronte, or Manly for less crowds
- **BridgeClimb vs Walk:** Climb is expensive but iconic; walking across is free with great views
- **Vivid Sydney:** Free light festival (May-June) - book accommodation early

Neighborhoods & Districts

Circular Quay & CBD

- **Character:** Iconic harbor landmarks, business district, major transport hub
- **Must-See:** Opera House, Harbour Bridge, Royal Botanic Garden, Museum of Contemporary Art
- **Food:** Harbor-view restaurants (expensive), food courts (cheaper)
- **Transport:** Circular Quay train/ferry/bus hub - best connected area
- **Stay Here If:** First-time visitor, want to be central (expensive)

The Rocks

- **Character:** Historic area, cobblestone streets, Sydney's oldest neighborhood
- **Must-See:** Weekend markets, historic pubs (Lord Nelson, Hero of Waterloo), Museum of Contemporary Art
- **Food:** Historic pubs, waterfront dining, market food
- **Transport:** Walk from Circular Quay
- **Visit For:** History, markets (weekends), pub culture

Darling Harbour

- **Character:** Tourist-focused waterfront precinct, family attractions, convention center
- **Must-See:** SEA LIFE Aquarium, WILD LIFE Sydney Zoo, Chinese Garden, Cockle Bay

- **Food:** Chain restaurants, food courts, harbor dining
- **Transport:** Light rail, Town Hall station, ferry
- **Stay Here If:** Traveling with kids, convention attendee

Surry Hills

- **Character:** Hip inner-city suburb, trendy cafes, boutique shopping, creative vibe
- **Must-See:** Crown Street (shopping and dining), Brett Whiteley Studio, cafes
- **Food:** Best brunch in Sydney, specialty coffee, multicultural restaurants
- **Transport:** Central station nearby, buses, walkable from CBD
- **Stay Here If:** Foodie, want local vibe, LGBTQ+ friendly

Bondi

- **Character:** Famous beach, surf culture, backpacker and tourist hub
- **Must-See:** Bondi Beach, Bondi Icebergs, Bondi to Coogee coastal walk (6km, stunning!)
- **Food:** Beach cafes, brunch culture, health-conscious options
- **Transport:** Bus 333, 380 from Bondi Junction station
- **Stay Here If:** Beach lover, active lifestyle, social scene

Manly

- **Character:** Beach town feel, laid-back, peninsula between ocean and harbor
- **Must-See:** Manly Beach, Shelly Beach (snorkeling), Corso walking street
- **Food:** Fish and chips, beachfront cafes, gelato
- **Transport:** Ferry from Circular Quay (30 min, scenic!)
- **Stay Here If:** Want beach escape from city, relaxed vibe

Newtown

- **Character:** Alternative, multicultural, student area (near Sydney Uni), street art
- **Must-See:** King Street (shopping, vintage, cafes), street art, independent theaters
- **Food:** Thai town, vegan options, quirky cafes, cheap eats
- **Transport:** Newtown station, buses
- **Visit For:** Alternative culture, live music, budget dining

Food & Dining

Australian Specialties

- **Flat White:** Iconic Australian coffee (espresso with microfoam milk) - originated here or NZ
- **Smashed Avo (Avocado on Toast):** Brunch staple, Sydney perfected it
- **Lamingtons:** Sponge cake coated in chocolate and coconut
- **Pavlova:** Meringue dessert with cream and fruit (Aussies claim they invented it, not NZ!)
- **Meat Pie:** Savory pie, often eaten at sporting events or from bakeries
- **Tim Tams:** Chocolate biscuits (buy a pack!)
- **Vegemite:** Yeast spread (acquired taste - use sparingly on toast with butter)
- **Barramundi:** Australian fish, delicious grilled
- **Kangaroo:** Lean game meat, sustainable choice
- **Prawns:** Aussies say "shrimp on the barbie" but call them prawns!

Coffee Culture (Serious Business)

- **Cafe Culture:** Sydneysiders are coffee snobs (in a good way)
- **Flat White:** Order this, not latte
- **No Starbucks:** Failed in Australia - locals prefer independent cafes
- **Brunch:** Huge brunch culture, cafes packed on weekends
- **Smashed Avo:** Yes, it's real, yes it's everywhere, yes it's delicious
- **Surry Hills/Newtown:** Best cafe scenes

Dining Customs

- **Tipping:** Not mandatory but appreciated - 10% for good service
- **BYO:** "Bring Your Own" alcohol at many restaurants (corkage fee \$5-10)
- **Meal Times:**
 - Breakfast: 7:00-10:00 (brunch until 14:00 weekends)
 - Lunch: 12:00-14:00
 - Dinner: 18:00-21:00 (earlier than Europe)
- **RSA:** Responsible Service of Alcohol - venues can refuse service if intoxicated
- **Licensed vs Unlicensed:** Some restaurants don't serve alcohol (BYO only)

Where to Eat

- **Cafes:** Breakfast/brunch kings - try Surry Hills, Newtown, Bondi
- **Fish Markets:** Sydney Fish Market (Pyrmont) - ultra-fresh seafood, sushi
- **Food Courts:** CBD food courts (cheap, diverse), Westfield (mid-range)
- **Chinatown:** Dixon Street (Haymarket) - Asian cuisine, late night
- **Circular Quay:** Expensive but iconic harbor views
- **Darling Harbour:** Tourist-focused, chain restaurants

Price Guide

- **Budget:** \$15-25 per person (food courts, casual cafes, fish and chips)
- **Mid-Range:** \$35-60 per person (good restaurants, pub meals)
- **Fine Dining:** \$100+ per person (Quay, Bennelong, hatted restaurants)
- **Coffee:** \$4-5.50 for flat white/cappuccino
- **Beer:** \$8-12 for schooner (425ml) at pub

Special Dietary Needs

- **Vegetarian/Vegan:** Widely available, especially in Newtown, Surry Hills
- **Gluten-Free:** Most cafes/restaurants have GF options
- **Halal:** Available, especially in Auburn, Lakemba (Western suburbs)
- **Food Allergies:** Taken seriously, inform staff

Transportation

From Kingsford Smith Airport (SYD)

- **Train:** Airport Link to City (13 min, \$19.59 - expensive due to private station fee)
- **Bus:** Route 400 to Bondi Junction (\$3.73 with Opal), various routes to city
- **Taxi:** \$45-55 to CBD (30 min), fixed fares to some areas
- **Uber/Rideshare:** Similar to taxi, \$45-65 depending on area
- **Shuttle:** Shared shuttle services (\$20-30)
- **Airport Pickup:** Some hotels offer pickup (inquire)

Pro Tip: Airport train is convenient but expensive. Uber/taxi often similar price, especially for 2+ people or with luggage.

Opal Card (Essential!)

- **What:** Contactless smart card for all public transport
- **Where to Get:** Airports, train stations, newsagents, 7-Eleven
- **Cost:** Free card, minimum \$10 top-up
- **Daily Cap:** \$17.80 weekdays, \$8.90 weekends/public holidays (unlimited travel after cap)
- **Transfers:** Free transfers within 60 min
- **Sunday:** \$2.80 cap on Sundays (cheapest day to explore!)
- **Tap On/Off:** ALWAYS tap on and off (or charged maximum fare)

Trains

- **Coverage:** Extensive suburban network, best for longer distances
- **City Circle:** Loop connecting major CBD stations (Circular Quay, Town Hall, Central)
- **Frequency:** 10-30 min depending on line and time
- **Hours:** ~4:30-midnight (some 24-hour on weekends)
- **Key Stations:** Central (main hub), Circular Quay (harbor), Town Hall (CBD), Bondi Junction (eastern beaches bus connection)

Buses

- **Coverage:** Comprehensive, reaches areas trains don't (beaches, North Shore)
- **To Bondi:** 333, 380 from Bondi Junction station
- **To Manly:** 100s routes from city
- **Real-Time:** Use Google Maps or Transport NSW app for live times
- **Payment:** Opal card only (no cash)

Ferries (Must Experience!)

- **Iconic:** Manly Ferry is a tourist experience AND transport
- **Routes:** Circular Quay to Manly (30 min, \$8.90), Taronga Zoo, Watsons Bay, Parramatta
- **Opal Works:** Use Opal card, counts toward daily cap
- **Views:** Best way to see harbor (Opera House, Harbour Bridge)
- **Private Ferries:** Captain Cook Cruises (tourist ferries, don't use Opal, more expensive)

Light Rail

- **Lines:** L1 (Dulwich Hill), L2/L3 (Randwick/Kingsford, Circular Quay)

- **Useful For:** Darling Harbour, Chinatown, Inner West, Randwick
- **Payment:** Opal card
- **Frequency:** 8-15 min

Taxis & Rideshare

- **Taxis:** Yellow and abundant, hail on street or taxi ranks
- **Uber:** Widely used, often cheaper than taxis
- **Didi/Ola:** Alternative rideshare apps
- **Cost:** CBD to Bondi ~\$35-45, CBD to airport \$45-55

Driving

- **Not Necessary:** Public transport excellent in city
- **Parking:** Expensive (\$15-60 per day), scarce in CBD and beaches
- **Tolls:** Many roads have tolls (electronic, need E-tag or pay within 3 days online)
- **Right-Hand Drive:** Opposite for US/EU drivers
- **Speed Cameras:** Everywhere, enforced strictly

Walking & Cycling

- **CBD:** Very walkable
- **Coastal Walks:** Bondi to Coogee (6km), Manly to Spit Bridge (10km), stunning
- **Bike Hire:** Limited bike lanes in city (improving), bike share available
- **Helmets:** Mandatory by law for cyclists

Cultural Tips & Customs

Australian Slang (Aussie Speak)

- **G'day:** Hello (yes, really used!)
- **Arvo:** Afternoon
- **Brekkie:** Breakfast
- **Servo:** Service station (gas station)
- **Bottle-O:** Liquor store
- **Thongs:** Flip-flops (NOT underwear!)
- **Esky:** Cooler

- **Ute:** Pickup truck
- **Barbie:** Barbecue
- **Fair dinkum:** Genuine, true
- **No worries:** You're welcome / it's fine (used constantly)
- **Heaps:** Very / a lot ("heaps good")

Social Customs

- **Laid-Back:** Australians are informal and relaxed
- **Mateship:** Friendship and loyalty valued highly
- **Self-Deprecating:** Don't brag, modesty is valued
- **Direct:** Communication is straightforward, not rude
- **No Worries Culture:** Easy-going attitude, don't stress
- **Beach Lifestyle:** Sun, surf, outdoor living is central to identity

Greetings & Interaction

- **Casual:** First names immediately, even in business (mostly)
- **Handshake:** Standard greeting
- **Eye Contact:** Expected, shows respect
- **Personal Space:** Similar to US/UK
- **Queue:** Line up patiently, cutting in line is rude

Dining & Drinking Etiquette

- **Shouting:** "Buying a round" - take turns buying drinks for group
- **Shout Back:** If someone "shouts you" a drink, return the favor later
- **Eat Early:** Dinner often 18:00-19:00 (earlier than Europe)
- **Tipping:** 10% appreciated but not mandatory
- **BYO:** Bringing own wine to restaurants is normal (corkage applies)

Beach Culture

- **Swim Between Flags:** Lifeguard-patrolled areas marked by red-yellow flags (essential for safety!)
- **Rip Currents:** Dangerous - always swim in patrolled areas
- **Beach Etiquette:** No glass bottles, clean up after yourself
- **Nudity:** Topless sunbathing generally not common (except designated beaches like Lady Bay)

- **Sun Safety:** "Slip, Slop, Slap" - slip on shirt, slop on sunscreen, slap on hat

Do's and Don'ts

DO: - Swim between the flags (lifeguard-patrolled) - Use sunscreen (UV is intense - skin cancer rates high) - Tip 10% for good service - Say "cheers" or "thanks" to bus drivers - Try Vegemite (sparingly!)

DON'T: - Feed or approach wildlife (including birds at beach) - Touch or pick up marine life (bluebottle jellyfish sting!) - Litter (Aussies are passionate about clean beaches) - Drink alcohol in public places (beaches, parks) - illegal in many areas - Underestimate the sun (sunburn happens fast!)

Safety & Health

Very Safe City

Sydney is one of the safest major cities in the world:

- **Low Crime:** Violent crime rare for tourists
- **Safe to Walk:** Day and night in most areas
- **Public Transport:** Safe at all hours (trains can be rough late at night, take Uber if concerned)
- **Beaches:** Patrolled beaches very safe, swim between flags

Sun Exposure (SERIOUS!)

Australia has the highest skin cancer rate in the world - sun safety is critical:

- **UV Index:** Extreme, even on cool/cloudy days
- **Sunscreen:** SPF 50+, reapply every 2 hours, water-resistant
- **Hat & Sunglasses:** Essential, not optional
- **Shade:** Seek shade 11:00-15:00 (peak UV)
- **Sunburn:** Happens in 10-15 minutes without protection
- **"Slip, Slop, Slap, Seek, Slide":** Slip on shirt, slop on sunscreen, slap on hat, seek shade, slide on sunglasses

Water Safety

- **Swim Between Flags:** Red-yellow flags mark lifeguard-patrolled safe zones

- **Rip Currents:** Dangerous currents that pull swimmers out to sea
 - If caught: Don't panic, don't swim against it, raise arm for help, float/swim parallel to shore
- **Bluebottle Jellyfish:** Common in summer, painful sting (not fatal), rinse with hot water
- **Beach Patrols:** Lifeguards work ~8:00-18:00 in summer (less in winter)
- **Rock Fishing:** Dangerous (people die every year) - not recommended

Wildlife Safety

- **Spiders/Snakes:** Rare in city, common in bush
 - Don't stick hands in holes/under rocks
 - Wear closed shoes hiking
 - Most spiders not dangerous, but seek medical help if bitten
- **Sharks:** Rare attacks, beaches have shark nets/patrols
- **Magpies:** Swoop during nesting season (Sep-Nov) - wear hat, avoid areas with signs
- **Marine Stingers:** Bluebottles in summer, box jellyfish rare in Sydney (more common in northern Australia)

Health & Medical

- **Emergency:** 000 (free from any phone, including mobiles without SIM)
- **Hospitals:** Excellent public (free with Medicare/reciprocal agreements) and private hospitals
- **Pharmacies:** Chemist Warehouse (cheap), Priceline, local pharmacies
- **No Reciprocal Agreement:** US, Canada - need travel insurance (essential!)
- **Reciprocal Agreements:** UK, Ireland, NZ, Nordic countries, Italy, Malta - limited free emergency care
- **Travel Insurance:** Essential for non-reciprocal countries (medical costs very high)
- **Prescriptions:** Need Australian prescription to fill (bring enough medication)

Pharmacies

- **Chemist Warehouse:** Discount chain (best prices)
- **Priceline, Terry White:** Other chains
- **Hours:** 9:00-18:00 or later (some 24-hour)
- **Over-Counter:** Many medications available (paracetamol, ibuprofen, antihistamines)

Emergency Numbers

- **All Emergencies:** 000 (police, ambulance, fire)
- **Non-Emergency Police:** Local police station
- **Poisons Information:** 13 11 26
- **Lifeline (Crisis Support):** 13 11 14

Practical Information

Electricity

- **Voltage:** 230-240V, 50Hz
- **Plug Type:** Type I (3-pin angled flat pins) - unique to Australia
- **Adapter:** Essential for US/EU/UK travelers
- **Where to Buy:** Airport, electronics stores, 7-Eleven, major stores

Money & Banking

- **Currency:** Australian Dollar (AUD, \$)
- **Notes:** \$5, \$10, \$20, \$50, \$100 (polymer, colorful, waterproof)
- **Coins:** 5c, 10c, 20c, 50c, \$1, \$2 (1c and 2c no longer used - prices rounded to nearest 5c for cash)
- **ATMs:** Everywhere, international cards accepted
- **ATM Fees:** \$2-3 per withdrawal, use major bank ATMs
- **Credit Cards:** Visa/Mastercard accepted almost everywhere, Amex less common
- **Tap & Pay:** Contactless payment ubiquitous, even small purchases
- **Cash:** Still useful for markets, some small cafes, but card preferred

Daily Budget

- **Budget:** \$100-150 (hostels, public transport, food courts, free attractions)
- **Mid-Range:** \$200-350 (hotels, restaurants, paid attractions, some taxis)
- **Luxury:** \$500+ (fine dining, harbourfront hotels, experiences)

Pharmacies & Toilets

- **Pharmacies:** Chemist Warehouse, Priceline, local chemists

- **Public Toilets:** Generally clean and available:
 - Beaches, parks (often free, clean)
 - Shopping centers, food courts
 - Train stations (some, not all)
 - McDonald's, cafes (buy something)
 - Download app: "Where's The Dunny" (Aussie slang for toilet!)

Business Hours

- **Shops:** Mon-Sat 9:00-17:30, Sun 10:00-16:00 (CBD and major shopping areas)
- **Malls:** Extended hours, often until 21:00 Thu, 17:00 Sun
- **Supermarkets:** Many open 6:00-midnight or 24 hours
- **Restaurants:** Lunch 12:00-14:00, dinner 18:00-21:00
- **Cafes:** 7:00-15:00 (brunch focused), some all-day

Public Holidays (Everything Closes!)

- **New Year's Day:** Jan 1
- **Australia Day:** Jan 26
- **Good Friday, Easter Monday:** March/April
- **Anzac Day:** April 25
- **Queen's Birthday:** June (second Monday)
- **Christmas/Boxing Day:** Dec 25-26

Tipping Culture

- **Not Mandatory:** Service staff earn decent wages
- **Appreciated:** 10% for good service at restaurants
- **Cafes:** Tip jars optional (coins/round up)
- **Taxis:** Round up
- **Hotels:** Not expected
- **No Pressure:** Don't feel obliged, but welcomed if you choose to

Internet & SIM Cards

- **Providers:** Telstra (best coverage), Optus, Vodafone
- **Tourist SIM:** \$30-50 for 28 days with data (10-40 GB)

- **Where to Buy:** Airport (convenience), Woolworths/Coles (cheaper), provider stores
- **WiFi:** Free in cafes, libraries, some public spaces
- **Coverage:** Excellent in cities, can be patchy in remote areas

Useful Apps

- **Transport NSW:** Official transport app, trip planning
- **Google Maps:** Excellent for Sydney, real-time public transport
- **Uber/Didi:** Rideshare
- **TripView:** Public transport times
- **Bureau of Meteorology (BOM):** Accurate weather, UV index
- **Dimmi/TheFork:** Restaurant bookings
- **AfterPay/Zip:** Buy now, pay later (if you have Aussie bank account)

Shopping

- **Westfield:** Shopping malls (Bondi Junction, CBD, Parramatta)
- **Pitt Street Mall:** CBD outdoor shopping street
- **QVB:** Historic shopping arcade, beautiful architecture
- **Paddy's Markets:** Chinatown market (Wed-Sun), bargains
- **Markets:** Paddington Markets (Sat), Rocks Markets (Sat-Sun), Glebe Markets (Sat)
- **GST:** 10% Goods and Services Tax included in prices
- **Tourist Refund:** Claim back GST on purchases \$300+ if leaving Australia within 60 days (TRS at airport)

Travel Responsibly: Australia's unique ecosystem is fragile. Don't feed wildlife, stay on marked trails, take only photos. Indigenous Australians are the traditional custodians of the land - acknowledge and respect their culture.

Pro Tip: Sydney is more than the Opera House and Harbour Bridge. Take a ferry to Manly, walk the coastal trails, explore Newtown's quirky shops, catch a game at the SCG (Sydney Cricket Ground), and chat with locals at a pub. Sydneysiders are friendly and proud of their city - ask for recommendations and you'll discover hidden gems. And please, don't skip the sunscreen!